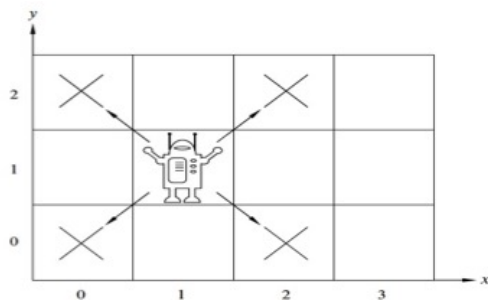


Structural induction example robot grid



Theorem: A robot on an infinite 2-dimensional integer grid starts at $(0,0)$ and at each step moves to diagonally adjacent grid point. This robot can / cannot (*circle one*) reach $(1,0)$.

Definition The set of positions the robot can visit Pos is defined by:

Basis Step: $(0,0) \in Pos$

Recursive Step: If $(x,y) \in Pos$, then

are also in Pos

Example elements of Pos are:

Lemma: $\forall (x, y) \in Pos \ (x + y \text{ is an even integer})$

Why are we calling this a lemma?

Proof of theorem using lemma: To show is $(1, 0) \notin Pos$. Rewriting the lemma to explicitly restrict the domain of the universal, we have $\forall (x, y) \ ((x, y) \in Pos \rightarrow (x + y \text{ is an even integer}))$. Since the universal is true, $((1, 0) \in Pos \rightarrow (1 + 0 \text{ is an even integer}))$ is a true statement. Evaluating the conclusion of this conditional statement: By definition of long division, since $1 = 0 \cdot 2 + 1$ (where $0 \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $1 \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $0 \leq 1 < 2$ mean that 0 is the quotient and 1 is the remainder), $1 \bmod 2 = 1$ which is not 0 so the conclusion is false. A true conditional with a false conclusion must have a false hypothesis: $(1, 0) \notin Pos$, QED. $\square$

Proof of lemma by structural induction:

Basis Step:

Recursive Step: Consider arbitrary $(x, y) \in Pos$. To show is:

$$(x + y \text{ is an even integer}) \rightarrow (\text{sum of coordinates of next position is even integer})$$

Assume **as the induction hypothesis, IH** that:

Fundamental theorem proof

Theorem: Every positive integer *greater than 1* is a product of (one or more) primes.

Before we prove, let's try some examples:

$$20 =$$

$$100 =$$

$$5 =$$

Proof by strong induction, with $b = 2$ and $j = 0$.

Basis step: WTS property is true about 2.

Since 2 is itself prime, it is already written as a product of (one) prime.

Recursive step: Consider an arbitrary integer $n \geq 2$. Assume (as the strong induction hypothesis, IH) that the property is true about each of $2, \dots, n$. WTS that the property is true about $n + 1$: We want to show that $n + 1$ can be written as a product of primes. Notice that $n + 1$ is itself prime or it is composite.

Case 1: assume $n + 1$ is prime and then immediately it is written as a product of (one) prime so we are done.

Case 2: assume that $n + 1$ is composite so there are integers x and y where $n + 1 = xy$ and each of them is between 2 and n (inclusive). Therefore, the induction hypothesis applies to each of x and y so each of these factors of $n + 1$ can be written as a product of primes. Multiplying these products together, we get a product of primes that gives $n + 1$, as required.

Since both cases give the necessary conclusion, the proof by cases for the recursive step is complete.

Strong induction making change proof idea

Suppose we had postage stamps worth 5 cents and 3 cents. Which number of cents can we form using these stamps? In other words, which postage can we pay?

11?

15?

4?

$$\begin{aligned} &CanPay(0) \wedge \neg CanPay(1) \wedge \neg CanPay(2) \wedge \\ &CanPay(3) \wedge \neg CanPay(4) \wedge CanPay(5) \wedge CanPay(6) \\ &\neg CanPay(7) \wedge \forall n \in \mathbb{Z}^{\geq 8} CanPay(n) \end{aligned}$$

where the predicate $CanPay$ with domain $\mathbb{N}$ is

$$CanPay(n) = \exists x \in \mathbb{N} \exists y \in \mathbb{N} (5x + 3y = n)$$

Proof (idea): First, explicitly give witnesses or general arguments for postages between 0 and 7. To prove the universal claim, we can use mathematical induction or strong induction.

Approach 1, mathematical induction: if we have stamps that add up to n cents, need to use them (and others) to give $n + 1$ cents. How do we get 1 cent with just 3-cent and 5-cent stamps?

Either take away a 5-cent stamps and add two 3-cent stamps,

or take away three 3-cent stamps and add two 5-cent stamps.

The details of this proof by mathematical induction are making sure we have enough stamps to use one of these approaches.

Approach 2, strong induction: assuming we know how to make postage for **all** smaller values (greater than or equal to 8), when we need to make $n + 1$ cents, add one 3 cent stamp to however we make $(n + 1) - 3$ cents.

The details of this proof by strong induction are making sure we stay in the domain of the universal when applying the induction hypothesis.